

# Finding Evidence

## Study Guide - Arguments & Sources

### 1. Learning goal

Locate the specific sentence, fact, example, or data point that most directly supports a stated claim.

### 2. What this skill means

Evidence answers the question, "What in the source gives us a reason to believe this claim?" Strong evidence is not merely related to the topic. It connects directly to the exact claim being tested.

### 3. Do not confuse it with

A relevant detail may still be weaker than a more direct piece of evidence. Also separate evidence from the author's recommendation, explanation, or prediction.

### 4. How GED-style questions may ask it

Questions may ask: "Which detail best supports the claim?", "Which evidence is most direct?", "Which detail would be least useful?", or "Which additional evidence would strengthen the argument?"

### 5. Repeatable method

- Underline the exact claim in the question.
- Turn the claim into a test: what would I need to see to believe this?
- Scan the source for facts or examples that answer that test.
- Prefer direct evidence over background information.
- Re-read the claim and evidence together to confirm the connection.

## 6. Worked example

A tutoring center says evening hours improve access. During the pilot, 41 percent of evening visitors reported that daytime work or family duties had prevented them from attending earlier sessions.

Question: Which detail most directly supports the access claim?

Reasoning: The 41 percent figure directly connects evening attendance to barriers that existed during daytime hours.

Best answer: The report that 41 percent of evening visitors could not attend earlier because of work or family duties.

## 7. Common traps

- Choosing a true detail that does not support the exact claim.
- Choosing the author's conclusion instead of the evidence behind it.
- Picking dramatic information when a quieter detail is more directly relevant.

## 8. Diagnostic help

- If your choice is only about the general topic, restate the exact claim before looking again.
- If your answer sounds like advice or a prediction, check whether it is actually evidence.
- If two details fit, ask which one most directly measures or demonstrates the claim.

## 9. Quick check

A pilot cafeteria line opened ten minutes earlier. Average first-period tardiness among students who used the cafeteria fell from 14 to 7 cases per week.

What evidence most directly supports the claim that the earlier opening may reduce tardiness?

**Check yourself:** The drop from 14 to 7 weekly tardiness cases among cafeteria users.